

Helios Sourcing Group — Corporate Travel Policy

v3.4 — effective 2026-08-01

Signed: Mei Watanabe, CFO · David Eze, Chief People Officer

1. Scope and Authority

This document governs all overseas business travel funded by Helios Sourcing Group. It supersedes any prior versions distributed before 2026-08-01.

Compliance is mandatory for sales, sourcing, quality, logistics, and engineering travel. Exceptions require written CFO sign-off (see §4.6 Override Clause).

Coordinators must verify every leg of a proposed itinerary against §2 (Budget), §3 (Contracted Suppliers), and §4 (Operational Rules) BEFORE issuing booking instructions to the team.

2. Per-Night Accommodation Budget Caps (USD)

All amounts are post-tax all-in (i.e. equivalent to total_rate.lowest in modern OTA APIs). Pre-tax displays must be labeled separately.

Per-Night Accommodation Budget Caps (USD)

Region	Standard (USD/night)	Premium (USD/night)
Greater China (Tier 1: Beijing/Shanghai/Shenzhen)	280	380
Greater China (Tier 2: Yiwu/Hangzhou/Suzhou)	220	300
Vietnam (HCMC, Hanoi)	240	320
Thailand (Bangkok, Chiang Mai)	250	300
Singapore	320	460
Japan (Tokyo, Osaka)	300	420

All amounts are post-tax all-in (i.e. equivalent to total_rate.lowest in modern OTA APIs). Pre-tax displays must be labeled separately.

Tier classification per the Helios Procurement Master List (revised quarterly).

3. Contracted-Supplier Hotel Allowlist

INITIAL bookings must be made with the following contracted properties. Off-allowlist initial bookings are non-reimbursable except under §4.6 Override. CORRECTIONS issued during audit (i.e. when an initial booking is found to violate any §4 operational rule) MAY search the wider dataset for a §4-compliant alternative — the audit reviewer should propose the canonical alternative per §4.7, regardless of allowlist membership. (Corrections that happen to fall on the allowlist are equally acceptable; corrections that fall outside the allowlist must still be §4-compliant.)

Shenzhen

- Hampton by Hilton Shenzhen Futian Huaqiangbei
- Hotel Novotel Shenzhen Watergate
- Atour Hotel Shenzhen Huaqiang North
- Shanshui Trends Hotel North Huaqiang

Yiwu

- Hampton by Hilton Yiwu International Trade Market
- Crowne Plaza Yiwu Expo
- Best Western Premier Yiwu Ocean Hotel
- Holiday Inn Yiwu Center by IHG

Ho Chi Minh City

- JW Marriott Hotel & Suites Saigon
- Sheraton Saigon Grand Opera Hotel
- Pullman Saigon Centre
- ibis Saigon Airport Hotel

Bangkok

- Mercure Bangkok Sukhumvit 11
- Wyndham Garden Bangkok Sukhumvit 42
- Walton Suites Sukhumvit Bangkok
- Holiday Inn Express Bangkok Sukhumvit (TBC by Q4)

4. Operational Rules

§4.1 — Cancellation grace floor

All bookings on trips lasting 7 calendar days or longer (inclusive) MUST carry a minimum 48-hour cancellation grace window. Non-refundable rates are PROHIBITED on these trips.

§4.2 — Flight arrival window

Inbound flights to any leg's first overnight city MUST have a scheduled local arrival time NOT between 22:00 and 05:00 inclusive (this protects rest periods before client meetings and reduces taxi-pool risk). Among compliant options for the same leg, prefer the LATEST arrival within the window — this maximises productive use of in-transit hours and minimises idle pre-meeting time.

§4.3 — Mobility accommodations

Coordinators must consult the per-trip team intake (Alex's pre-trip email) for accessibility needs. When a team member requires mobility accommodation, hotels marked 'Not wheelchair accessible' or lacking explicit wheelchair-accessibility in `amenities` are PROHIBITED.

§4.4 — Dining-diverse neighbourhood

When the client communicates a religious dietary requirement (halal, kosher, etc.), the team's host hotel MUST be located in a dining-diverse neighbourhood. For Bangkok, the approved halal-friendly neighbourhood list is: SUKHUMVIT (the broad corridor), ASOKE, PHROM PHONG, THONG LOR, NANA. The hotel's `nearby\_places[].name` array (case-insensitive) must reference at least one of these neighbourhoods. Properties whose nearby_places lists only the airport or unrelated landmarks DO NOT satisfy this requirement, even if the property's own name contains 'Sukhumvit' (the property name alone is not sufficient — the nearby_places relationship to a corridor station/landmark is what proves the location).

§4.5 — Team co-location

Teams of 3 or more travelling on the same leg must be co-located at a single hotel property (no splits across two or more hotels). Client-perception consistency outweighs marginal cost savings — see §4.6 if cost forces an exception.

§4.6 — Override clause

Written communications from the CFO or Finance Controller (via approved corporate email) may tighten any budget cap for a specific leg or trip. When a written override is in effect, the STRICTER of the two limits applies. Loosening below this policy requires CFO signature on a Travel Exception Memo (filed with HR).

§4.7 — Tiebreaker for canonical alternative

When multiple compliant alternative properties exist for a given correction, the canonical alternative is selected as follows (apply in order until one alternative remains): (a) the property with the lowest post-tax per-night rate (the SerpAPI `rate\_per\_night.lowest` field, which is already expressed per night — do NOT divide further); (b) for markets where no OTA-listed prices are surfaced, the FIRST entry in the §3 contracted-supplier allowlist for that city; (c) alphabetic order on the property name. This rule applies to audit corrections as well as initial selection.

5. Out-of-Scope Reminders (informational)

These items are NOT new rules but reminders of long-standing standard practices. Coordinators do not need to flag adherence; only flag deviations.

- Carry-on limit: 1 bag per traveller (airline-standard).
- Personal expenses (souvenirs, recreation) are self-billed and out of scope.
- Meal per diem applies only when no client-hosted meal is in the agenda; otherwise no per-diem is reimbursed.
- Currency conversion for reimbursement uses the Helios FX rate snapshot on the day of trip departure.